

Freight Distribution Network

User Guide - v9.01

Logain Industries Freight Distribution Network v9.01 - User Guide

For X3: Farnham's Legacy (tested) - Terran Conflict and Albion Prelude untested

by Logain Abler - 31 October 2026

At a glance

IMPORTANT - FDN STARTS PAUSED

After a first install or a Master Reset, FDN is paused. Setting a Distribution Centre does not start it. Open the Artificial Life plugin settings and switch FDN on.

The Freight Distribution Network (FDN) moves wares between your own stations for you. You pick one or more docks as **Distribution Centres** (DCs). FDN then keeps your factories supplied with resources, collects their products into the DCs, and can buy and sell wares with NPC stations.

Version 9.01 is a rework of FDN v8.04. It adds several Distribution Centres linked as a **DC Network**, a range rule, an optional Energy Cell cost for transfers and a reworked menu.

WARNING

Tested on X3: Farnham's Legacy only. Terran Conflict and Albion Prelude are untested.

NOTE

This release is not signed. If you install the `.spk` package, your game runs in Modified mode.

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Important before you install

> **WARNING**
> Use v9.01 only on saves that have never had an older version of FDN installed. Saves that have had older versions of FDN, including v8.04, are not guaranteed to work. Back up your saves first.

- Start a fresh game, or use a save that has never had FDN on it.
- Keep a copy of your save folder before you install.
- The package is not signed. Installing the `.spk` puts your game in Modified mode.

Requirements

Item	Details
Game	X3: Farnham's Legacy 1.3 (tested). X3: Albion Prelude 3.3 and X3: Terran Conflict: untested.
FL Unofficial Patch 1.3.20	Optional. When it is present, FDN adds an entry to the game's script options menu.
Community Plugin Configuration 1.61	Required for the `.spk` install (via X Plugin Manager); not needed for the manual zip install.
X Plugin Manager	Needed only for the `.spk` package. Use the latest version.
Save	A fresh save, or one that never had FDN (see above).

Installation

A. With X Plugin Manager (.spk)

Community Plugin Configuration is required for this install.

1. Close the game and back up your saves.
2. Open the latest X Plugin Manager and allow it to install unsigned packages (your game then runs in Modified mode).
3. Install `Logain Industries FDN v9.01` from the `.spk` and make sure it is enabled for your game.
4. Start the game and load your save, then follow **First-time setup**.

B. Manual install (loose zip)

Community Plugin Configuration is not needed for this install.

1. Close the game and back up your saves.
2. Copy every `.xml` file from the zip's `scripts` folder into your game's `scripts` folder (see the table below).
3. Copy the text files from the zip's `t` folder into your game's `t` folder.
4. Start the game and load your save, then follow **First-time setup**.

Game	Script and text folders (Steam default)
X3: Farnham's Legacy	`Steam\steamapps\common\X3 Terran Conflict\addon2\scripts` and `...\addon2\t`
X3: Albion Prelude	`Steam\steamapps\common\X3 Terran Conflict\addon\scripts` and `...\addon\t`
X3: Terran Conflict	`Steam\steamapps\common\X3 Terran Conflict\scripts` and `...\t`

If you installed the game somewhere else, use the same sub-folders in your own game folder.

> **NOTE**
>
> FDN ships one text file per game language: `9910-L044.xml` English; `9910-L049.xml` German (machine translated, pending review by a native speaker); and English copies for French (`L033`), Italian (`L039`), Russian (`L007`), Spanish (`L034`), Polish (`L048`) and Czech (`L042`), so menus show English text instead of `ReadText` in those games. Copy all of them.

First-time setup

IMPORTANT - FDN STARTS PAUSED

After a first install or a Master Reset, FDN is paused. Setting a Distribution Centre does not start it. Open the Artificial Life plugin settings and switch FDN on.

While FDN is paused, the Config menu shows `FDN Enabled: OFF` at the top.

Switch FDN on

1. Open the **Gameplay** menu and choose **Artificial Life Settings**. This opens the **AL Plugins** screen.
2. Find `Logain Industries: FDN v9.01` and set it to **Yes**.
3. Bind a key to the `FDN` hotkey under **Controls > Interface**, in the **Extensions** section (needed if you do not have Community Plugin Configuration, for example after a manual zip install). The hotkey is registered only while FDN is switched on.



Figure 1 - Gameplay menu. The list ends with Artificial Life Settings, Mission Director, Plugin Configurations and the FDN entry.

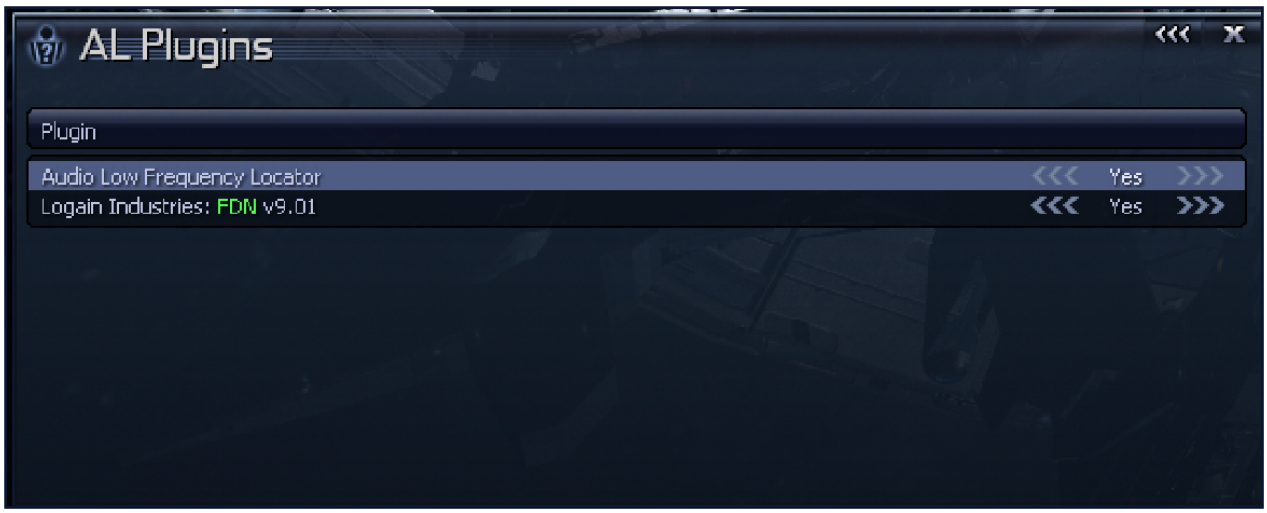


Figure 2 - AL Plugins screen with Logain Industries: FDN v9.01 set to Yes.



Figure 3 - Controls > Interface. The Extensions section lists FDN (here bound to Shift+=).

Create the primary DC

1. Open FDN with the hotkey, the Community Plugin Configuration entry, or the **FDN** entry at the bottom of the **Gameplay** menu.
2. In the **FDN Config Menu**, choose one of your docks as the Distribution Centre. It becomes the **primary DC** and FDN assigns your stations to it.



Figure 4 - FDN Config Menu: current Distribution Centre, Dynamic Menus, Global Options, Network: Range and Energy Cell Cost, Debug Settings, Master Reset and Menu Options.

Add more DCs

1. Open **Distribution Centre Network** from the **Menu Options:** footer.
2. Choose **Add** Distribution Centre. Only docks within DC Network range of the primary DC are listed.
3. Confirm. A network can have up to 16 DCs.

> **TIP**
>
> If a dock you expect is missing from the Add list, it is out of range of the primary DC. Raise the base range or the DC Network range multiplier in the Config menu, or make a closer dock the primary.

Using FDN

Distribution Centres

A DC is one of your docks that stores wares for the network. Each factory and dock is served by one home DC. Wares can be held as physical stock in the dock or as virtual stock that FDN tracks for you.

Multi-DC and the DC Network

With more than one DC, FDN links them into a DC Network. The **Distribution Centre Network** page lists your DCs with their range, the stations they serve and their Energy Cell stock. From it you can `Add` a DC, `Remove` one, `Make primary`, or `Open` a DC's page. The **DC Network Links** group lists the linked DC pairs.

- A dock can only become a DC when it is within DC Network range of the primary DC.
- A DC that loses its link (for example after `Make primary` or a range change) stays a DC and shows a red `Not linked to primary` mark.
- The last DC cannot be removed. When you remove a DC, its stations go to the nearest other DC.

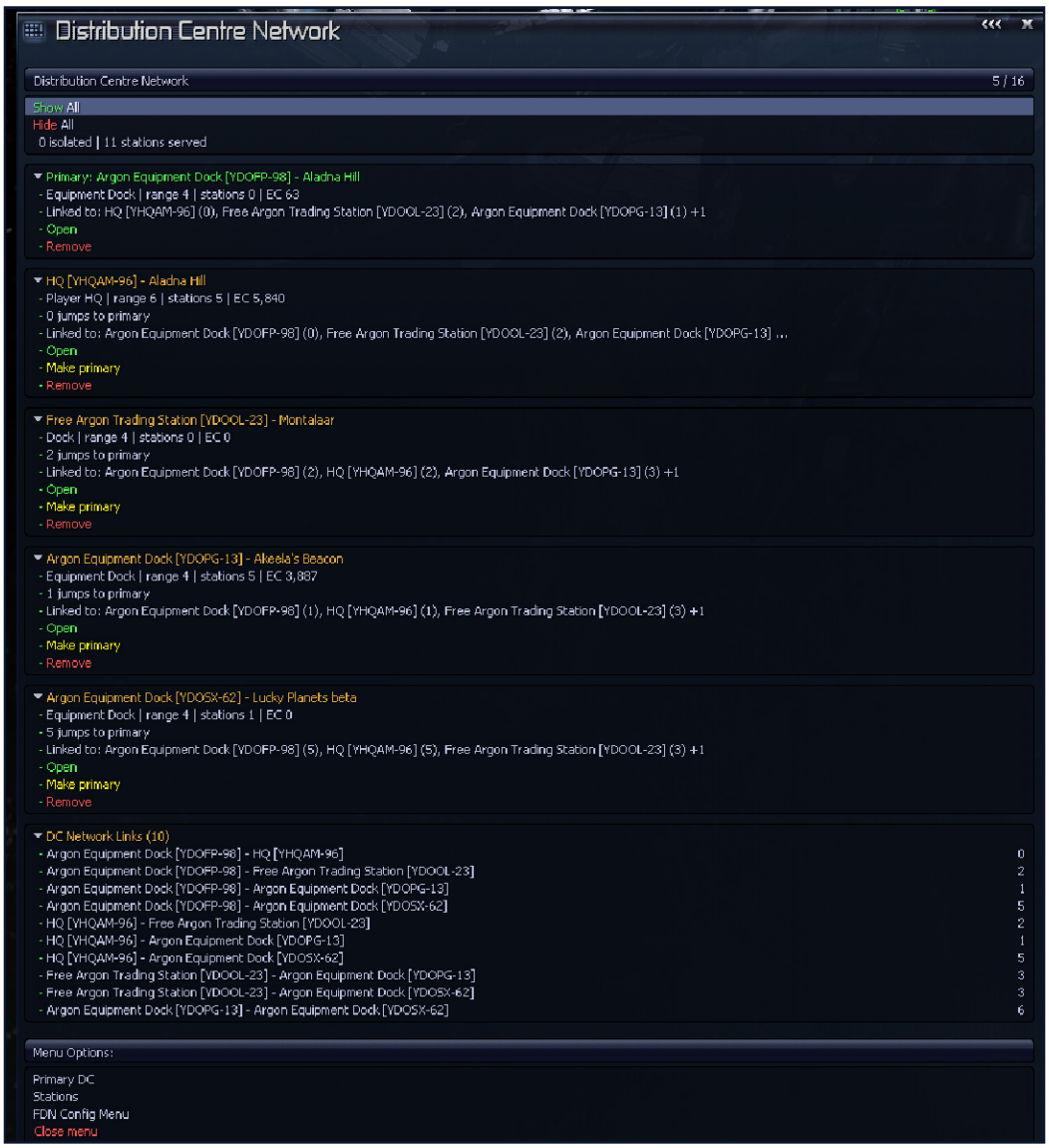


Figure 5 - Distribution Centre Network menu: 5 of 16 DCs, the primary DC, each DC's range, stations served, Energy Cells and links, and the DC Network Links list.

Range

Each DC has a range in jumps. It is the per-DC override from the DC page, or else the base range from the Config menu plus a type value:

DC type	Added to the base range
Player HQ	+2
Equipment Dock	0
Trading Station	0
Other docks	-1

The range is never less than 1. Two DCs are linked when the jumps between them are no more than the **DC Network range multiplier** (1-5, default 2) times the smaller of their two ranges.

Reserve floor

A DC never gives away or pays out Energy Cells below its reserve floor: a percentage of its capacity, 25% by default. Set the global value in the Config menu and override it per DC on the DC page.

Energy Cell transfer cost

When **Energy Cell transfer cost** is on, each transfer is paid in Energy Cells by the DC. If the paying DC is short, other DCs help. If the network cannot pay, the transfer is deferred and you get one logbook message telling you to top up your DCs. Moving wares by hand to or from a DC is cancelled when the cost cannot be paid. The **Running cost** row on a DC page shows what that DC has paid, with `Reset` running cost.



Figure 6 - Distribution Centre view: range and reserve floor for this DC, Running cost, and the wares list with Buy At, Sell At and Physical/Virtual Storage.

Ware options

On a station's ware page you can set, per ware: Maintain stock at level, Remote access past stock level, Sell ware past stock level, Allow FDN to buy ware, Buy ware at/or below, Sell ware at/or above,

and Pass Surplus to Distribution Centre (On, Off, or the global default). The global default **Surplus to Distribution Centre** is On, Off or v8 compatible.

> **NOTE**
> Pass Surplus on a DC has no effect (DCs do not pass surplus to themselves). Maintain on a DC only affects Energy Cell pulls.

Menu layout

- Every page ends with **Menu Options:**, which links to the other main pages (**Primary DC**, **Stations**, **Distribution Centre Network**, **FDN Config Menu**), followed by **Back** where there is a page to return to, and `Close menu`.
- Back returns to the page you came from. Opening a page already in the history goes back to it. Esc works as Back; `Close menu` exits all pages.
- In the game's own menus FDN appears as `FDN` in green.
- Command colours: green for add / on, amber-brown for neutral commands (make primary, move, transfer), red for remove / reset / off.

Farnham's Legacy Station Manager

Stations run by FL Station Manager are removed from the FDN network with a message. If the DC itself is run by Station Manager, FDN pauses until you choose a new DC.

Settings reference

Setting	What it does	Default
FDN Enabled	Switched in the Artificial Life plugin settings; shown at the top of the Config menu.	Off after first install or Master Reset
Range limit	Turns the range rule on or off.	On
Base station range (jumps)	Base range of every DC before the type value.	3 (1-20)
DC Network range multiplier	Links DCs when jumps ≤ multiplier x the smaller DC range.	2 (1-5)
Energy Cell transfer cost	Transfers are paid in Energy Cells by the DCs.	On (fresh install)
Reserve floor (% of capacity)	Energy Cells a DC keeps back.	25 (0-100)
Range for this DC (jumps)	Per-DC override on the DC page; 0 = use the type value.	Not set
Reserve floor for this DC (%)	Per-DC override; -1 = use the global value.	Not set
Surplus to Distribution Centre (default)	Applies to every ware set to Default.	On (fresh install)
Auto Manage Factories	FDN manages new factories when it first sees them.	On
Master Reset	Returns FDN to default settings, clears the DC list and FDN data on your stations, keeps the network settings above; FDN stays paused.	-

Compatibility

- X3: Farnham's Legacy 1.3, with or without Unofficial Patch 1.3.20: tested.
- X3: Albion Prelude 3.3 and X3: Terran Conflict: untested (multi-DC and the new menus have not been tried there).
- Community Plugin Configuration 1.61: required for the `.spk` install (via X Plugin Manager); not needed for the manual zip install.
- XRM: unconfirmed, not tested.

- Litcube's Universe: not supported.
- Production Modules: not directly compatible. Support is planned for a later release (date to be decided, depending on interest).
- FDN uses text page and log file id 9910.

Uninstall

1. In the Artificial Life plugin settings, switch FDN off. This removes its Config entry and unregisters the hotkey.
2. Save the game, then close it.
3. Remove the package in X Plugin Manager, or delete the FDN files you copied (`al.LI.FDN.*`, `al.plugin.LI.FDN.*`, `lib.LI.FDN.*`, `plugin.LI.FDN.*`, and every `9910-L0*.xml` text file). After a manual (zip/copy) uninstall, leave `lib.BW.isAP.xml` in place: it is DrBullwinkle's script and other mods may use it. An X Plugin Manager (.spk) uninstall removes `lib.BW.isAP.xml` too, as the package ships it; if another mod needs it, reinstall it from DrBullwinkle's own download.

> **WARNING**
> Virtual stock held by FDN is lost when FDN is removed or reset. Move what you need into physical storage first.

Known issues and limitations

- Tested on Farnham's Legacy only.
- Saves that ever had an older FDN, including v8.04, are not supported.
- Trading Stations and Equipment Docks get the range type value by type; equipment docks of races other than Argon count as other docks (-1). For the Energy Cell cost, a Trading Station still counts as an other dock.
- A long multi-hour test (many factories, several DCs, cost on) is still open.
- FDN buys only from stations that will trade with you. If your notoriety with a station's race is too low for a ware (the station shows it in red with "your notoriety is too low"), FDN skips that seller for 30 minutes game time and tries another. The log shows `TRADE block seller` and `TRADE skip seller`. Raising your notoriety with that race fixes it.

Troubleshooting and FAQ

FDN does nothing after I set a DC.

FDN is paused. Switch it on in the Artificial Life plugin settings. The Config menu shows **`FDN Enabled: OFF`** while it is paused.

The hotkey does nothing.

The hotkey is registered only while FDN is switched on. Switch FDN on, then bind a key to **`FDN`**.

A dock is missing from the Add Distribution Centre list.

It is out of range of the primary DC. See **Range**.

A DC shows "Not linked to primary".

It is too far from the primary DC for the current ranges. Raise the range or multiplier, or make another DC primary.

I see "Energy Cells short - transfers deferred".

Your DCs could not pay the Energy Cell cost. Top up Energy Cells at your DCs, or switch the cost off in the Config menu.

A factory never gets a ware that NPC stations sell.

Your notoriety with the seller's race may be too low for that ware (often Paranid or Teladi). FDN then skips that seller; the log shows `skip seller`. Trade with or work for that race to raise your notoriety, or buy from another race.

A menu shows "ReadText".

The game is using an old text file. Copy all the v9.01 `9910-L0*.xml` files into your game's `t` folder.

Changelog v9.01 (summary)

- Up to 16 Distribution Centres (DCs) linked as a DC Network, with a primary DC and a Distribution Centre Network page.
- Range rules: a dock can join only when it is linked to the primary DC; DCs that are not linked are marked.
- Network settings: range limit, base station range, DC Network range multiplier, reserve floor, and per-DC range and reserve floor overrides.
- Optional Energy Cell cost for transfers, with help between DCs, deferral warnings and a running cost page per DC.
- Trading Stations and Equipment Docks get the same range as DCs.
- Reworked menus: Menu Options footer on every page, Back / Esc navigation, consistent colours.
- Configurable Surplus to Distribution Centre default; Master Reset clears FDN data on every station.
- Farnham's Legacy: stations run by Station Manager are removed from the network; FDN entry in the Gameplay menu; hotkey fallback.
- Language files: English; German (machine translated, pending native review); English copies for French, Italian, Russian, Spanish, Polish and Czech.
- Many fixes and shared libraries; see `CHANGELOG.md` for the full list.
- Fresh saves only. FDN starts paused until you switch it on. Albion Prelude and Terran Conflict are untested.

Credits

FDN by Logain Abler (Logain Industries).

`lib.BW.isAP` by DrBullwinkle (used by four FDN menu scripts, shipped unchanged).

X Plugin Manager and `.spk` tooling by Cycrow.

Licence

Free to use, change and share as you see fit, as long as credit is given.

Reporting a problem

When you report a problem, please attach a copy of `log09910.txt` (switch on **Supply Debug** under **Debug Settings** in the FDN Config Menu first).

Items to confirm (TBC list)

#	Item
1	Terran Conflict script/text folder (game folder `scripts` and `t`): standard layout, not checked on a TC install.